

likely to happen. And that means when I buy multiple shirts with varied designs I am avoiding insults - not duped by marketers.

When you look at a scene of 'Downtown Abbey', the *maids* dress the 'lady' in varied dresses and jewellery that the lady flaunts at grand balls. Back then, the ultra-wealthy had options. When we headed to the grocery store, we knew what we were going to buy. If the store didn't have atta, we simply returned home and didn't look at that bottle of perfume. Whatever we owned we cherished, as the money was limited and production wasn't grand-scale to make things cheap.

But the concept of *shopping* changed all that. Suddenly, things that were only accessible to the ultra-rich were opened to all of us. We didn't need a brown leather glove and a black woolen one - but we liked to match them with outfits. That same maid from Downton Abbey who has worked in a shabby maid's uniform, now has the choice to buy something for herself from years of hard work. Suddenly, that dress and necklace that she dreamt of, is within reach. Although deep down if you ask: does she need it? No. Why? Because she's never going to a Ball and find Mr. Dashing Diplomat.

In fact, we buy things because of the emotions that go with them. Buying several shirts mean I'm Mr. Sharp and not Mr. Pickeasy. Getting a gym membership means you're not buying time to lift weights but you bought an idea of the dream body. When you buy drinking glasses, you're thinking of cricket night with friends and not the value of glass in your hand. If it came to drinking juice while watching cricket matches we could all have done with aluminium glasses but the glassy glasses elevate the happiness emotion.

Quite sadly, '*We're never buying what we think we're buying.*' We buy stuff because we believe we need them. On the contrary, we buy things because we desire the emotions attached with them.

To Buy or Rent a Home

Likewise, when it comes to buying a home, we often hear statements like

- *Rent is throwing money down the drain.*
- *Buying is any-day better than renting.*